

KEEPSAKE

Figma Design Direction + Artifact Display Case Concept

Purpose: Capture the newly proposed Figma workflow and physical-artifact display system as a focused design brief that can later be folded into the full Keepsake Bible.

1. Figma as Part of the Keepsake Workflow

Figma should become an active design stage for Keepsake rather than merely a place to make mockups after coding. The goal is to decide how an object, material, state, and interaction should look before implementing it in React/CSS or building a final 3D asset in Blender.

- **Proposed workflow:** idea -> Figma component/material study -> interaction states -> approved visual specification -> React/CSS or Blender/Three.js implementation.
- **Immediate Figma targets:** scrapbook page, photo component, artifact component (beginning with a concert ticket), and plastic sleeve/material system.
- **Design system:** define reusable variables/tokens for paper, ink, wood, shadows, spacing, typography, room lighting, day/night states, and seasons.
- **Reason:** this reduces improvised CSS decisions and gives future coding work a visual target.

Instagram Design Reference

Hamad Tanveer / @uiux_hamad: https://www.instagram.com/uiux_hamad?stkn=eGhvZG02bWdqOGFs

The profile is being used as a technique reference rather than a direct aesthetic template. Direct automated access to Instagram was throttled during review, so the individual techniques below should be treated as a design shortlist to test in Figma rather than a complete catalog of the profile.

2. Figma Techniques Worth Testing for Keepsake

Technique	Keepsake use
Progressive blur / glass	Plastic scrapbook sleeves, CRT glass, window glass, subtle photo glare and reflections.
Directional shadows	Make photos, tickets, drawings, clippings, stickers, and artifacts share one believable light direction.
3D / isometric mockups	Prototype books, tickets, boxes, cards, and room objects in dimensional form before Blender production.
Variables / design tokens	Paper, ink, wood, light, seasons, spacing, typography, night mode, and Lights Out states.
Gradients / lighting	Warm Firewatch-like sunsets, window glow, CRT glow, desk-lamp illumination, seasonal ambience.
Auto Layout	Settings, privacy controls, toolbars, archive/search UI, responsive editor controls.
Text on path	Handwritten scrapbook labels, curved sticker text, decorative artifact labels.

3. Directional Lighting as a Shared Rule

Figma and the eventual website should share a consistent light model. If the desk lamp is positioned above-left, page elements should cast shadows in a compatible direction. This can later become dynamic: Lights Out Mode may strengthen the desk lamp as the dominant light source, while daytime window light may soften or redirect the effect.

Design principle: shadows are not decorative presets. They are evidence that all objects occupy the same physical world.

4. Artifact Display Case

Add a tall glass-front display case to the Keepsake room, inspired structurally by the supplied reference cases: multiple illuminated shelves, clear front panels, strong vertical framing, and enough depth for individual objects to read clearly. The Keepsake version should be warmer and more handcrafted - wood or aged painted framing, imperfect glass, and soft shelf lighting rather than a modern retail-showroom finish.

Role in the artifact ecosystem

Memory Box	Display Case
Tickets	Childhood toys
Letters / postcards	Trophies / medals
Newspaper clippings	Souvenirs
Artwork / drawings	Figurines
Recipes / programs	Sports memorabilia
Mostly flat/scanned keepsakes	Physical 3D keepsakes and heirlooms

5. Phone Scan -> 3D Keepsake Artifact

A future capture workflow could allow a user to scan a meaningful real-world object with a phone and turn it into an optimized 3D artifact for the display case. Keepsake should integrate an existing photogrammetry/depth-capture pipeline rather than inventing the reconstruction algorithm from scratch.

- **Capture:** user chooses Add Artifact and photographs/scans the object from many angles; supported phones may also contribute depth information.
- **Reconstruction:** an external/native reconstruction pipeline creates the 3D model.
- **Cleanup:** remove background, correct orientation, simplify geometry, optimize textures, and generate a web-friendly GLB/gITF display asset.
- **Preservation:** keep the original capture/source separately from the optimized room model.
- **Placement:** user previews the object, chooses a shelf, scales/rotates it within safe limits, and saves its position.

6. Artifacts Should Be Memories, Not Decoration

Every display-case object should have an Artifact Record. Clicking an object can move the camera closer, allow rotation/inspection, reveal a short personal note, and offer links to related scrapbook pages through Memory Trails. A childhood baseball, for example, might connect directly to a Summer 2006 scrapbook spread.

Key rule: the display case should communicate 'these things mattered to me,' not 'look at my achievements.' Achievement objects may appear occasionally, but personal artifacts remain the focus.

7. Display Case + Existing Keepsake Systems

- **Lights Out:** shelf lighting can remain softly illuminated when the room darkens, creating another atmospheric light source.
- **Memory Trails:** a physical artifact can link to photos, pages, books, places, dates, and related artifacts.
- **Memory Box:** flat memorabilia and 3D artifacts share one archival concept but use different room presentations.
- **House Has Memory:** the case can remember shelf placement and the user's preferred arrangement.
- **House Has Manners:** case animations and lighting never interrupt active scrapbook reading/editing.
- **Privacy:** visibility and interaction permissions apply to the model itself, its description, and linked memories.

8. Proposed Technical Shape

Artifact

- id / ownerId
- artifactType
- sourceAsset
- displayAsset
- thumbnail
- title / year / notes
- modelAsset (.glb) [optional]
- modelSource: scan | generated | authored
- shelfPlacement [optional]
- memoryLinks[]
- visibility / interaction permissions
- provenance metadata

9. Recommended Build Order

- Design the display case and a few artifact states in Figma now.
- Keep the current coding focus on refactoring and the generic PageElement/multi-photo scrapbook foundation.
- Build the persistent Artifact/Memory Box data model after backend storage exists.
- Build the room and display case after the core scrapbook is stable.
- Add manually authored/uploaded 3D artifacts first.
- Add phone-based 3D scanning only after the display case, storage pipeline, optimization limits, and privacy model are proven.

10. Figma Deliverables to Create Next

- Keepsake Design System v1: paper, ink, wood, lighting, shadows, spacing, typography, seasons.
- Scrapbook page component and plastic-sleeve material study.
- Photo component with normal/selected/dragging/rotated states.
- Artifact component beginning with a concert ticket.
- Display case: closed room view, focused view, selected artifact, empty shelf, populated shelf, Lights Out state.
- 3D-scan onboarding concept: capture -> processing -> preview -> shelf placement.

Long-term concept: Keepsake should preserve not only photographs of a person's life, but also the meaningful physical objects that accompanied it. The Memory Box preserves flat/documentary artifacts; the Display Case preserves spatial/physical artifacts; the scrapbook and Memory Trails connect both back into stories.